

GENDER



BENDERS

Rita Aiyar vs Yash Mody Changing The Default Language On The Computer



Uneasy at the beginning, Rita's confidence increases with each successive click. She accesses the Control Panel from the Start Menu and soon enough, clicks on the 'Regional and Language Options' icon. The dialog box pops open and displays 'Regional Options', 'Languages' and 'Advanced'. Rita clicks 'Languages' and then 'Advanced', but to no avail. She comes back to 'Regional Options' and spots the drop-down box that lists 100-odd languages. Just in time to be first!



Yash maintains his composure. He clicks 'My Computer' and opens the Control Panel. Hesitantly, he clicks the 'Fonts' option, and spends almost a minute in a fruitless search. He returns to Control Panel, and finally spots the 'Regional and Language Options' icon. By the powers that be, he follows the same path as Rita—wastes time on 'Languages' and 'Advanced' before he spots the drop-down box and heaves a sigh of relief!

reporters in Bangalore at the launch of its Web conferencing and enterprise IM service in India. "We can't underestimate the huge development effort involved in providing language functions. OEMs should start offering it in June," he said. Microsoft has already launched Windows starter in Malaysia, Thailand and Indonesia.

XP Starter Edition, to be

priced far cheaper than XP Home and Professional, will be rolled out first in Hindi and "will be quickly introduced in 10 other Indian languages," Singh said. He said Microsoft had already worked out details with computer manufacturers such as HP and IBM on the price of the software, which will be bundled with PCs. Microsoft eventually plans to work with local assemblers.

BEAM, DON'T SWIPE

Mobile Phones As Credit Cards

Now, a software/hardware combination can let consumers in India use their cell phones as credit cards.

Customers simply aim their cell phone at the payment counter, and their purchase is charged to their account. The move has excited interest in cell phone circles because it is perceived as 'high-tech' and innovative, and also has considerable utilitarian appeal.

Standard Chartered and Visa have launched the service, called m-Wallet, in Mumbai and Bangalore.

Murali M Natrajan, head of consumer banking, India and Nepal, Standard Chartered, said, "The launch of the m-Wallet makes us pioneers in ushering mobile commerce in India."

How it works is, your credit card information is downloaded to your Infrared-capable mobile phone. When you are done purchasing, you need to stand near the payment terminal—a standard terminal, with added IR capability—and your credit card information gets beamed across.

Users need to first download a Java midlet onto their phones, which does the work of handling security and communication with the terminal.

Paying this way is a good thing. First off, you don't need to carry your credit cards around and worry about them getting lost—it's a lot harder to

lose your phone than your credit card. Second, if your phone does get stolen, it cannot be used for payments unless your PIN is keyed in. Another advantage is that the receipt gets stored on your mobile, so you don't have to worry about lost bills.

The problem, of course, is that not too many retailers have IR-enabled payment counters.

PIRATES TO BE 'TOLD OFF'

Invention To Turn Off Music Pirates

Up until now, we have seen copy protected music CDs and Digital Rights Management attempt to stop unauthorised copying of music files (or CD ripping). Now, a pair of New York inventors believe they can thwart music pirates by secretly burying an anti-piracy warning in a track, which is disinterred if the copyright has been abused, *New Scientist* reports.

With help from the US Air Force Research Laboratory, the inventors, Mark Bocko and Zeljko Ignjatovic, professors of electrical engineering, found they could bury around 20 Kb of speech data in a song without affecting how it sounds. The speech data, which is the warning—for instance, a voice from a record company boss, berating the user for piracy—exploits the fact that the tones of a musical instrument consist of a complex

Internet Explorer 7.0

There's a lot of buzz going on about IE7, the latest version of Internet Explorer, slated for a beta release this summer. As it says on the Microsoft Internet Explorer Weblog, developers have gotten a clear message from users that SP2 is a good thing, and that they want more security—in the browser.

Some details about IE7 have emerged, and if the rumours are true, it will have tabbed browsing, an inbuilt news aggregator, and will be integrated with Microsoft's anti-spyware product. Other features include no cross-domain scripting and/or scripting access, an improved SSL user interface, and simpler printing from within the browser.

Buzzword
of the MONTH